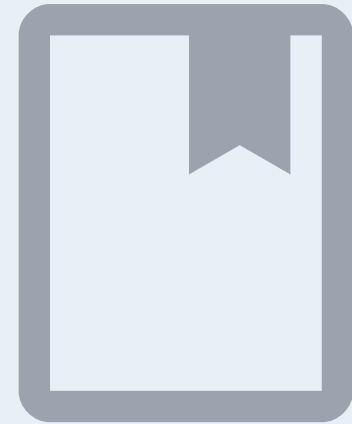


Important N2 Japanese Grammar Structures

Overview and Analysis of N2
Grammar Patterns

Presented by Sapiens AI Team



～一方だ

Ngày càng... (Sự thay đổi theo một chiều hướng)

Increasingly, following a single direction

General Meaning

This grammar point expresses a continuous, one-sided change or trend in a situation or action. It signifies that a state is consistently moving in one direction, either increasing or decreasing, without reversal. It emphasizes the ongoing nature of this trend.

Characteristics

This pattern highlights an intensifying or worsening trend. While it is frequently used to describe negative changes (e.g., worsening conditions), it can also apply to neutral or positive continuous changes (e.g., increasing numbers). The key characteristic is that the change is strictly unidirectional, with no indication of reversal.

Form

～Verb (dictionary form) + 一方だ

Illustrative Examples



Spreading anxiety

住民の不安は広がる一方だ。

The anxiety of residents is continuously spreading.



Increasing phone subscribers

携帯電話の加入者数は増加する一方だ。

The number of mobile phone subscribers is constantly increasing.



Decreasing birth rate

日本では出生率は下がる一方で、上がる気配を見せない。

In Japan, the birth rate continues to decline, showing no sign of increasing.

Visual Trend

f Subscribers (in thousands)



02. ～一方で

① Nêu lên hai sự việc đối lập

Dùng để chỉ hai khía cạnh đối lập của cùng một vấn đề.

 Fun aspect of study
abroad

Học hỏi & Trải nghiệm

Vừa vui vừa khó khăn

"Lâu sống là **vui**, nhưng cũng **khó khăn**."

② Song song đồng thời tiến hành

Mô tả hai hành động song song, không liên quan đến nhau.

 Online teaching

Công việc

Song song với

"Tôi làm **thông dịch** và **dạy Japanese online**."

Distinction from ～一方だ

～一方で (ippou de) dùng cho hai khía cạnh đối lập của cùng một thing hoặc hai hành động song song.

～一方だ (ippou da) chỉ một xu hướng thay đổi liên tục, không có hành động song song.

● ～一方だ

"在日本，出生率は下がる一方で、上がる気配を見せない。"

3. Grammar Pattern ～反面 / 半面 (Hanmen)

Meaning

Indicates two contrasting aspects or opposing sides of an issue or situation, often translated as 'on the other hand,' 'while,' or 'although' expressing a trade-off or contradiction.

Characteristics

- ✔ Expresses two opposing aspects of an issue/situation.

Structure

- ▶ Verb (dictionary form)+ 反面/半面
- ▶ い-adjective+ 反面/半面
- ▶ な-adjective (stem)+ な/である + 反面/半面
- ▶ Noun + である+ 反面/半面

Examples

「この車は、空気を汚さない反面、価格が高いという欠点がある。」

This car doesn't pollute the air, but on the other hand, it has the drawback of being expensive.

「現代の若者は、情報に接する機会が多い。その反面、体験が不足している。」

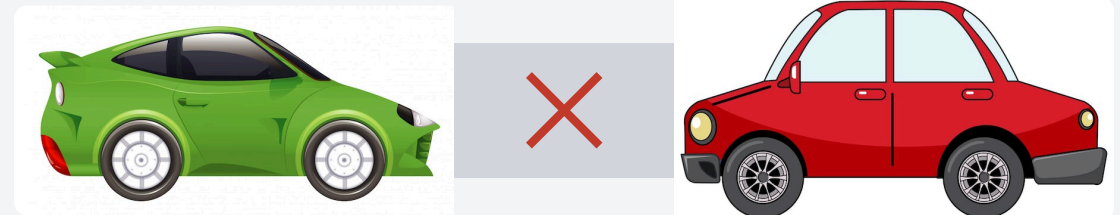
Young people have many chances to access information, but they lack real-life experience.

「この布は水に強い反面、熱には弱い。」

This fabric is strong against water, but on the other hand, it's weak against heat.



Illustration: A car with opposing aspects



4. Grammar Pattern: ～一方だ / ～ばかりだ

JLPT N2 Grammar

Focus: Meanings and Usage

Continually, increasingly (negative trend)

Expresses a continuous change in one direction, often used for undesirable or worsening trends.

日本語: 成績は悪くなるばかりです。

English: Performance keeps getting worse.

日本語: 政府への不満は高まる一方です。

English: Dissatisfaction with the government keeps growing.



Only, just (after completing other tasks)

Indicates that after all other necessary tasks or actions have been completed, only one remaining action or state exists.

日本語: やれることは全部やった。あとは祈るばかりだ。

English: I've done everything I can. All that's left is to pray.

日本語: 全員揃いました！あとは小林さんが来るのを待つばかりです。

English: Everyone has gathered! All that's left is to wait for Kobayashi.



～上 (に)

Meaning: Not only... but also (in addition to)

Adds further information, emphasizes degree. Often used to present multiple aspects, sometimes with a negative or compounding implication.

Example 1

佐藤さんはほぼ毎日遅刻する上によく会議で居眠りする。

Sato san not only is almost always late, but also often dozes off in meetings.

Example 2

この島のバスは、路線が複雑な上、運賃も高いので、利用者は少ない。

Bus routes on this island are not only complex, but fares are also expensive.



Lateness



Dozing Off



Complex Routes



Expensive Fares

Meaning

After A... then B (A is a necessary condition)

Structure

Verb in ta-form (V**た**形) + 上で

Examples

医師と相談した上で、ワクチンを接種するかどうかご判断ください。

Hãy quyết định có tiêm vắc xin hay không sau khi trao đổi với bác sỹ.

こちらが契約書です。内容をご確認の上、サインをお願いします。

Đây là hợp đồng. Xin hãy ký sau khi xác nhận nội dung.

Visual Flowchart

Trao đổi với bác sỹ



Quyết định tiêm vắc xin



Ký hợp đồng

08. ～上(で)

Meaning

In the process of, in the case of, when performing V...

Trong quá trình, trường hợp, khi thực hiện V...

Formation

Verb-dictionary form + 上で

Application

Refers to necessary conditions or important considerations within a process or situation.

Example 1: Learning Foreign Languages



Japanese:

"外国語を勉強する上で、いい教科書は欠かせない。"

A good textbook is essential for learning foreign languages.

Example 2: During an Interview



Japanese:

"面接を受ける上で、気を付けるべきことは何でしょうか。"

Things to be careful about during an interview.

Japanese Grammar: ～上は / ～上(で)は

1. From the Perspective of, Regarding, On/In...

This usage indicates looking at something from a particular standpoint, according to certain rules, or within a specific context. It often highlights a contrast between a theoretical framework (or a calendar, legal standpoint, etc.) and reality.

Formation:

Noun + の上では / Noun + 上では

Examples:



Japanese: `暦の上ではもう春ですが、寒い日がまだまだ続いています。`

It's spring on the calendar, but cold days still continue.



Japanese: `有休をとって他社の面接を受けるのは、法律の上では問題ない。`

Taking paid leave to interview at another company is not a problem under the law.



SPRING ON CALENDAR



LEGAL ISSUES

2. Once A, Then B Is Natural/Certain

This expresses that once a certain condition or situation (A) has been established, a particular course of action, responsibility, or resolution (B) naturally or necessarily follows. It often implies a strong sense of duty or inevitability.

Formation:

Verb (dictionary form) + 上は / Verb (casual, past form) + 上は

Examples:



Japanese: `目標を決めた上は、それに向かって前向きに行動しなければならない。`

Once a goal is set, positive action must be taken towards it.



Japanese: `その仕事を引き受けた上は、最後まで責任を持ってやり遂げる。`

Once you've accepted that job, you must see it through responsibly to the end.



10. ~ (よ) うとする

Meaning: To intend to, to try to, to want to do something

Meaning

Expresses the intention, attempt, or desire to do something.

Formation

Verb (Volitional Form) + とする

The volitional form of a verb ends in 'う' (for 1-2 syllables) or 'よう' (for 3+ syllables).

行く (iku) → 行こうとする (ikou to suru)

食べる (taberu) → 食べようとする (tabeyou to suru)

する (suru) → しようとする (shiyou to suru)

About to make a call



The doorbell rang just as I was about to make a call.

Japanese: 電話をかけようとしたとき、玄関のベルが鳴りました。

Trying to explain one's situation



I tried to explain my situation, but she absolutely refused to accept it.

Japanese: 自分の立場を説明しようとしたが、彼女はどうしてもそれを受け付けなかった。

Supporting her desire to marry a foreigner



Although I outwardly opposed it, I actually supported her desire to marry that foreigner.

Japanese: 表面的には反対していたが、本当は彼女がその外国人結婚しようとしているのを支持していた。

12. ～思い

Meaning: Thought, feeling, sensation...

Suy nghĩ, cảm thấy...

Ý nghĩa

Biểu đạt suy nghĩ, cảm thấy...

1. Felt abruptly pulled back to reality by the news

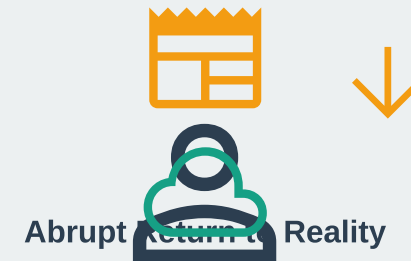
Japanese: その知らせにはっと現実には引き戻される思いがした。

Vietnamese: Nhận được tin đó tôi cảm thấy như thể mình bị kéo về thực tế một cách đột ngột.

2. The sense of responsibility is greater than the joy

Japanese: 喜びというより責任感の方が多くてその大きさに身が引き締まる思いです。

Vietnamese: Cảm giác trách nhiệm lớn hơn so với niềm vui nên tôi cảm thấy căng thẳng trước trách nhiệm to lớn đó.



 Balance Scale

Responsibility

Joy

Responsibility Outweighing Joy

13. 欠かせず / 欠かせない

Indispensable / Cannot be omitted

Meaning

"Indispensable, cannot be omitted, never fails to"

Vietnamese: **Không thể thiếu**

 Puzzle icon with a missing piece labeled 'understanding'

1. Cross-cultural Understanding

Japanese: 異文化間の交流には、相手を理解しようという姿勢が欠かせない。

English: An attitude of understanding is indispensable in cross-cultural exchange.

Vietnamese: Tinh thần cố gắng hiểu đối phương là điều không thể thiếu trong giao lưu giữa các nền văn hóa khác với nhau.

2. Computer for Student Life

Japanese: 私は大学生なのでコンピューターも日常生活に欠かせないものです。

English: A computer is essential for student life.

Vietnamese: Tôi là sinh viên nên máy tính cũng là vật không thể thiếu trong sinh hoạt thường ngày.

 Desk icon with books, notebook, and glowing computer

13. ～くらい / ～くらいだ

To the extent that, so much that...

Meaning

「～くらい / ～くらいだ」: Đến mức, đến nỗi...



So scared I wanted to scream

怖くて怖くて、大声で叫びたいくらいだった。



So frustrated I wanted to cry

テニスでこんな点しか取れないなんて、くやしくて泣きたいくらいだ。



Japanese
Proficiency
Icon

If one's Japanese is as good as his

彼くらい日本語が上手なら、どんな仕事だってできるだろう。

15. ～くらいなら

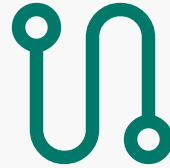
Meaning: If A..., then B is better / Rather than A..., B is better



Throw away computer

"そのパソコン、捨てるくらいなら私にください。"

If you're going to throw away that computer, give it to me.



Quit halfway

"途中で止めるくらいなら始めない方がいい。"

If you're going to quit halfway, it's better not to start.



Reconcile / Die

"あんな奴と仲直りするくらいなら、むしろ死んだほうがましちゃう。"

Rather than reconcile with such a person, I'd rather die.

Summary & Practice

Review of Grammar Patterns

～一方だ
～一方で
～反面 / 半面
～ばかりだ (negative)
～ばかりだ (only)
～上 (に)
～た上 (で)
～上 (で) (during)
～上で (は) / ～上 (は)
～上は
～ (よ) うとする
～思い
欠かさず / 欠かせない
～くらい / ～くらいだ
～くらいなら

Practice Exercises



Sentence Completion (問題 1)

- 20 questions



Sentence Rearrangement (問題 2)

- 4 questions

Important Notes for Usage

Focus on context, nuance, and common pitfalls for correct grammar application.

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